

CHRISTMAS LESSONS OF WORSHIP

TEXT: Matthew 2:1-12 *“Now after Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod the king, behold, wise men from the East came to Jerusalem, (2) saying, “Where is He who has been born King of the Jews? For we have seen His star in the East and have come to worship Him.” (3) When Herod the king heard this, he was troubled, and all Jerusalem with him. (4) And when he had gathered all the chief priests and scribes of the people together, he inquired of them where the Christ was to be born. (5) So they said to him, “In Bethlehem of Judea, for thus it is written by the prophet: (6) ‘But you, Bethlehem, in the land of Judah, are not the least among the rulers of Judah; For out of you shall come a Ruler who will shepherd My people Israel.’ ” (7) Then Herod, when he had secretly called the wise men, determined from them what time the*

star appeared. (8) And he sent them to Bethlehem and said, “Go and search carefully for the young Child, and when you have found Him, bring back word to me, that I may come and worship Him also.” (9) When they heard the king, they departed; and behold, the star which they had seen in the East went before them, till it came and stood over where the young Child was. (10) When they saw the star, they rejoiced with exceedingly great joy. (11) And when they had come into the house, they saw the young Child with Mary His mother, and fell down and worshiped Him. And when they had opened their treasures, they presented gifts to Him: gold, frankincense, and myrrh. (12) Then, being divinely warned in a dream that they should not return to Herod, they departed for their own country another way.”

INTRO: (Relate the Christmas story, and explain that there are at least five hidden

lessons of “**WORSHIP**” that we can learn from the historical account of this first Christmas ever!)

Let us look briefly at these five lessons:

WORSHIP WILL TAKE US ON A SPIRITUAL JOURNEY!

Matthew 2:1 *“Now after Jesus was born in Bethlehem of Judea in the days of Herod the king, behold, wise men from the East came to Jerusalem.”*

We are not sure how far these wise men had to travel to get to Bethlehem, but we must assume that it was quite a distance:

The “**WORSHIP**” of the wise men caused them to embark upon a “**JOURNEY!**”

When one enters into true “**WORSHIP**” it will take us on a “**JOURNEY!**”

Our “**WORSHIP**” of GOD should take us on a “**JOURNEY**” rather than to leave us sitting still!

“**WORSHIP**” will cause us to go from death to life!

If we embark on a spiritual journey, it will be our “**WORSHIP**” that transports us from where we are, to where GOD wants us to be!

WORSHIP WILL TAKE US OUT OF FAMILIAR SURROUNDINGS!

Matthew 2: 1-8 tells us that neither the wise men nor Herod knew exactly where the Christ Child was!

Herod wanted to find Him to kill him, the wise men wanted to find Him to worship Him. It was true then as it is now, people come to worship him with different motives.

The desire to “**WORSHIP**” the Christ,
brought the wise men from the kingdoms of
the east to Jerusalem!

The wise men were out of “**FAMILIAR
SURROUNDINGS**” just getting to
Jerusalem! Now they were being required to
go to Bethlehem!

Their “**WORSHIP**” removed them from
their comfortable “**FAMILIAR
SURROUNDINGS**”!

Our “**WORSHIP**” will cause us to sit
together in heavenly places in Christ Jesus!

**WORSHIP WILL BRING US TO OUR
KNEES AT THE FEET OF JESUS!**

Matthew 2:11 *“And when they had come
into the house, they saw the young Child
with Mary His mother, and fell down and
worshipped Him. And when they had*

opened their treasures, they presented gifts to Him: gold, frankincense, and myrrh.”

Please understand that these wise men, who were accustomed to being called for by a king, for advice, fell at the feet of baby Jesus and **“WORSHIPPED”**!

(Legion could identify with them!)

When we get a true vision of Him we will do the same!

(Someone asked - *“How many wise men came to **WORSHIP** Jesus?”* The answer - *“All wise people worship Jesus!”*)

WORSHIP WILL CAUSE US TO GIVE OUR VERY BEST!

Matthew 2:11 *“And when they had come into the house, they saw the young Child*

with Mary His mother and fell down and worshiped Him. And when they had opened their treasures, they presented gifts to Him: gold, frankincense, and myrrh.”

When we really begin to “**WORSHIP**” Him, we will have a desire to give up everything for him! Romans 12:1-2 “*I beseech you therefore, brethren, by the mercies of God, that you present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your reasonable service. (2) And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, that you may prove what is that good and acceptable and perfect will of God.*”

(Live Dead)

**WORSHIP WILL CAUSE US TO
LEAVE ANOTHER WAY!**

Matthew 2:12 “*Then, being divinely warned in a dream that they should not*

return to Herod, they departed for their own country another way.”

When we come into His presence to **“WORSHIP,”** we will most certainly leave another way!

We cannot come into His presence and **“WORSHIP”** without leaving another way!

- **“WORSHIP”** creates abandonment!
- When we truly **“WORSHIP”** we abandon ourselves...
- When we truly **“WORSHIP”** we abandon our sin...
- When we truly **“WORSHIP”** we abandon destructive relationships...
- When we truly **“WORSHIP”** we abandon bad habits and vices...
- When we truly **“WORSHIP”** abandon our path and follow His... *“If any man will come after me...” “I am crucified with Christ, nevertheless I live...”*